

In the spirit of our gaming direction this semester, you will be split into collaborative circles for the final project of the semester. Each circle will be expected to design a game to express a sociological concept/topic/problem and its effects on society. These games can take any form you so choose, ranging from dialogue games (like the one we played our first week) to scripted tabletop games. There will be two presentations associated with this project. The first will be an academic presentation and the second will be a demo of your created game during our final exam slot of finals week. As you begin to map out your game, keep in mind that you will need to lay out a convincing argument in your presentation as to why/how your game is sociological, the message it is looking to convey, and how you plan to convey said message.

Circles will be randomly assigned in the interest of fairness. No two circles will be allowed to do a project on the same topic. To accomplish this, the instructor **must be notified** of your topic **before** you begin work on the project. The topics will be first come, first served. So, it will be in your best interest to decide on a topic shortly after the circle assignments have been made.

Free Rider Policy

Given the notorious “free-rider” issue that many circles face—where one or more members provide no contribution to the project and leave the work to their colleagues—circles will be permitted to eject members if they find their respective contributions lacking. With that in mind, any ejections must be documented and approved by the instructor in advance. Circle members who have been ejected from their circles will be assessed a grade of 0% on the project grade, with the option to recover their project grade by completing the assignment entirely on their own.

Academic Presentations

The academic presentations are to be no less than 10 minutes and no more than 15 minutes in length. Each circle will be expected to explain the content of their game (including the messaging strategy of the game), why they chose their topic (make sure to address why the topic matters), and how they plan to market their game.

In addition to the above criteria, your academic presentation must 1) address the sociological issue/problem you are looking for your game to express or explore, 2) utilize at least six course concepts and two sociological theories, and 3) properly cite each of those concepts and theories (ideally using at least one course reading).

Your academic presentations will be assessed by the following:

- Sociological depth & accuracy
- Quality of theoretical integration into your game
- Clarity and organization
- Effectiveness of your argument and how prepared you are to respond to queries about it
- Time

Game Demos

The game demo presentations are to be no less than 15 minutes and no more than 20 minutes in length. You must make sure that your game is playable (though it does not need to be able to incorporate the entire class as “players”). In preparation for your demo, make sure you do the following:

1. Read the rules
 - Seems pretty basic, I know...but you'll be surprised how many folks demoing board games don't actually know all the rules to their game.
2. Practice explaining the rules
 - It's not only important to know how to play the game, but it's important to understand how best to teach others how to play the game.
3. Prepare a short game/session
 - Again, I know this seems basic, but make sure that you've prepared a session which can give players the essence of your game while being conscious of existing time limitations.
4. Make sure any/all win/lose conditions are clear
 - Remember that new players can be willing to play, understand the rules, and still end up dispassionate because they don't quite get how what they're doing changes the game.

Your game demos will be assessed by the following:

- How well did you explain your game to the public?
- Was your game engaging enough to hold your “customers' ” attention?
- How prepared were you for your demos (e.g. did you bring tabling or advertising materials/graphics to help “sell” your product, etc.)

You will be treated and graded as professionals for these presentations, so please **come dressed appropriately** (no pajamas). There may also be spontaneous question and answer sessions which may arise, so come to your presentations and demos **prepared**. So, make sure to come prepared to receive and provide questions.